

COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Rural Society and Agrarian Change - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / SESSION INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

Rural Society and Agrarian Change - Learner-v2 Complete Learning Session 6

SOURCE, PROGRESSION AND CURRENT-LINKAGE AUDIT 6

BASIC LEARNING SESSION 6

DEEP-REVIEW LEARNING CONTRACT 6

EVIDENCE, PYQ AND CURRENT-STATUS CONTROL 7

SESSION 1 - FOUNDATION - THE JAJMANI EXCHANGE 8

SESSION 2 - FOUNDATION - WHY JAJMANI CHANGED 9

SESSION 3 - FOUNDATION - AGRARIAN CLASS STRUCTURE 11

SESSION 4 - CORE - CASTE AND CLASS IN THE VILLAGE 12

SESSION 5 - CORE - THE DOMINANT CASTE 13

SESSION 6 - CORE - SRINIVAS'S VILLAGE EVIDENCE 15

SESSION 7 - CORE - DOMINANCE IS NOT LANDOWNERSHIP ALONE 16

SESSION 8 - CORE - GREEN REVOLUTION DIFFERENTIATION 17

SESSION 9 - CORE - WHY THE OUTCOME IS REGION-SPECIFIC 19

SESSION 10 - CORE - PANCHAYATI RAJ RESERVATION 20

SESSION 11 - CORE - REPRESENTATION AND SUBSTANTIVE POWER 21

SESSION 12 - CORE - THE RURAL-URBAN CONTINUUM 23

SESSION 13 - CORE SYNTHESIS - SCOPE DISCIPLINE IN A RURAL ANSWER 25

SESSION 14 - CORE SYNTHESIS - MEASUREMENT BOUNDARIES 26

SESSION 15 - CORE SYNTHESIS - ANSWER SPINE AND HONEST QUESTION STATUS 28

INDIAN SOCIETY DEEP-REVIEW CORE CONTROL 34

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION 34

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Jajmani system? 34

Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under Jajmani system? 35

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Jajmani system? 35

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Jajmani system? 35

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Hereditary personalised tie? 36

Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under Hereditary personalised tie? 36

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Hereditary personalised tie? 36

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Hereditary personalised tie?	36
Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Jajmani decline mechanism?	37
Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Jajmani decline mechanism?	37
Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Jajmani decline mechanism?	37
Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Jajmani decline mechanism?	37
Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Residual service ties?	38
Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under Residual service ties?	38
Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Residual service ties?	38
Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Residual service ties?	39
Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Agrarian class structure?	39
Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under Agrarian class structure?	39
Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Agrarian class structure?	39
Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Agrarian class structure?	40
Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Caste-class overlap in the village?	40
Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Caste-class overlap in the village?	40
Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Caste-class overlap in the village?	40
Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Caste-class overlap in the village?	41
Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Dominant caste?	41
Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under Dominant caste?	41
Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Dominant caste?	41
Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Dominant caste?	42
Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Rampura evidence?	42
Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under Rampura evidence?	42
Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Rampura evidence?	43
Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Rampura evidence?	43
Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Dominant caste is not the landowning class?	43
Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under Dominant caste is not the landowning class?	43
Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Dominant caste is not the landowning class?	44
Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Dominant caste is not the landowning class?	44
Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Green Revolution differentiation?	44
Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under Green Revolution differentiation?	45
Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Green Revolution differentiation?	45

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Green Revolution differentiation?	45
Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Region-specific outcome?	45
Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under Region-specific outcome?	46
Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Region-specific outcome?	46
Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Region-specific outcome?	46
Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Panchayati Raj reservation?	47
Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Panchayati Raj reservation?	47
Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Panchayati Raj reservation?	47
Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Panchayati Raj reservation?	48
Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Formal representation versus substantive power?	48
Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under Formal representation versus substantive power?	48
Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Formal representation versus substantive power?	49
Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Formal representation versus substantive power?	49
Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Rural-urban continuum?	49
Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under Rural-urban continuum?	50
Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Rural-urban continuum?	50
Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Rural-urban continuum?	50
Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Continuum in practice?	51
Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Continuum in practice?	51
Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Continuum in practice?	51
Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Continuum in practice?	51
Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Scope discipline on land law?	52
Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under Scope discipline on land law?	52
Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Scope discipline on land law?	52
Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Scope discipline on land law?	53
Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Periodic Labour Force Survey boundary?	53
Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Periodic Labour Force Survey boundary?	53
Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Periodic Labour Force Survey boundary?	54
Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Periodic Labour Force Survey boundary?	54
Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Employment data cannot prove village power?	54
Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Employment data cannot prove village power?	55
Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Employment data cannot prove village power?	55

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Employment data cannot prove village power?	55
Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Which resource now carries power?	55
Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Which resource now carries power?	56
Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Which resource now carries power?	56
Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Which resource now carries power?	56
Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?	57
Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?	58
Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?	59
Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?	60
PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE	60
TRANSPARENT ZERO-DIRECT-PYQ AUDIT	61
OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS	61
ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS	61
ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS	62
ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS	64
ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS	65
ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS	67
ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS	68
OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER	70
CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES	74
Rural Society and Agrarian Change: RAPID CONCEPT AND EVIDENCE MAP	74
Rural Society and Agrarian Change: CLOSE-OPTION AND CAUSAL TRAPS	75
Rural Society and Agrarian Change: ANSWER-WRITING SPINE	76
Rural Society and Agrarian Change: CURRENT-LINK AND DATA BOUNDARY	76
COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM	76

Rural Society and Agrarian Change - Learner-v2 Complete Learning Session

Authoring-only generation: 2026-09-02. No PDF was rendered and no tracker or index was mutated.

SOURCE, PROGRESSION AND CURRENT-LINKAGE AUDIT

- **Generation date:** 2026-09-02.
- **Repository-first evidence:** the Basic owner is taught first and preserved in full; the Advanced owner is retained only in the optional final teaching block.
- **OCR evidence:** Repository Markdown was primary. The OCR-searchable official General Studies Paper-I question papers held under books\mains and books\more_previous_papers were used only to confirm the wording of routed Mains PYQs. No official answer key, marking scheme, page precision or unsupported quotation was imported from them.
- **Qdrant:** not used; repository Markdown and available OCR context were sufficient.
- **PYQ integrity:** No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the audited routing ledgers or in the locally held official question papers is routed to rural society and agrarian change. This owner therefore records a transparent zero-direct-PYQ status rather than inventing a recent question, a marking scheme or an official key. The theme remains an older-pattern recurring examination area, and the six original solved Mains answers below prepare the four demand families the owner actually carries: jajmani change, dominant caste and village power, agrarian differentiation, and the rural-urban continuum. Adjacent land-reform, tenancy and poverty questions are owned by Economy and Panchayati Raj institutional design is owned by Governance, and neither is claimed here.
- **Live-link boundary:** No additional live official item was verified for this topic on 2026-09-02. Only the dated official anchors already carried by the repository owners are used, each with its issuing body and date. The package invents no caste, tribe, demographic or agrarian statistic, no legal or constitutional claim and no policy status.
- **Fact/inference discipline:** no current-affairs item, PYQ wording, figure or quotation is invented.

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

DEEP-REVIEW LEARNING CONTRACT

Control	Binding rule for this package
Syllabus boundary	Complete Indian Society Basic/Core is answer-complete before optional Advanced depth.
Concept method	Define and distinguish the institution, identity, process, legal category and measured indicator before analysis.
Sociological method	Structure/institution -> mechanism and agency -> differentiated group/region outcome -> feedback, resistance and qualification.
Evidence method	Claim -> named Indian community/region/institution/dataset -> analysis -> source-date-status or causal qualification.
Non-homogenisation	Caste, tribe, women, religion, region and rural/urban groups retain internal class, gender, locality and historical variation.
Boundary method	Constitutional right, statutory mandate, executive scheme, implementation and lived social outcome remain distinct.
Practice contract	Every solved item has demand decoding, a detailed examiner-grade model, executable timed/compression plan, marks rationale and answer-specific improvement.
Approval	This immutable successor remains approved: false pending explicit approval.

Canonical Basic/Core owner:

upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Indian-Society\basic\05_Rural-Society-and-Agrarian-Change.md

Canonical topic owner:

upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Indian-Society\basic\05_Rural-Society-and-Agrarian-Change.md

Optional Advanced owner:

upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Indian-Society\advanced\05_Rural-Society-and-Agrarian-Change.md

Official syllabus mapping:

upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Indian-Society\OFFICIAL-UPSC-SYLLABUS-MAPPING.md

EVIDENCE, PYQ AND CURRENT-STATUS CONTROL

- **Definition discipline:** close concepts and legal-administrative categories share a comparison axis and are never treated as synonyms.
- **Mechanism discipline:** correlation, temporal sequence and aggregate association do not establish causation; identify institutions, incentives, norms, power and agency.
- **Historical discipline:** colonial, constitutional, developmental, liberalisation and contemporary phases are separated without a linear tradition-to-modernity story.
- **Intersectional discipline:** overlapping caste, tribe, class, gender, religion, disability, region and life-course positions are analysed without creating a single homogeneous category.
- **India discipline:** use named communities, movements, institutions, cities, states and regional contrasts without stereotyping or treating one case as nationally representative.
- **Data discipline:** Census 2011, NFHS, PLFS, SRS, Agriculture Census, MPI and scheme claims retain source, reference period, release date, coverage and provisional/final status.
- **PYQ discipline:** repository routing ledgers and locally held papers control wording and metadata; reconstructed wording and unavailable official keys remain labelled.
- **Current-status note, rechecked 2026-09-02:** No additional live official item was verified for this topic on 2026-09-02. Only the dated official anchors already carried by the repository owners are used, each with its issuing body and date. The package invents no caste, tribe, demographic or agrarian statistic, no legal or constitutional claim and no policy status.

Live/official context sources recorded by the predecessor generation:

- No volatile live claim is necessary for the static sociological core.



Refreshed teaching navigation

Distinct embedded teaching-navigation image. The separate continuous Cārvāka-style flowchart package remains an independent at-a-glance artifact.

SESSION 1 - FOUNDATION - THE JAJMANI EXCHANGE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Evidence chain: Jajmani system - Hereditary personalised tie
Qualified use: Define the institution precisely before explaining its change.

Technical definition: The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Jajmani system - Hereditary personalised tie
Qualified use: Define the institution precisely before explaining its change.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- FOUNDATION
- The jajmani exchange
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- The defining feature
- Jajmani

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define The jajmani exchange, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use The defining feature for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

THE JAJMANI EXCHANGE

01. Jajmani system

|

v

02. Hereditary personalised tie

BOUNDARY -> The defining feature is the hereditary personalised tie, not the payment medium.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash.
- What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- The defining feature is the hereditary personalised tie, not the payment medium.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to The jajmani exchange.
- **Mains:** Define the institution precisely before explaining its change.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Jajmani system -> Hereditary personalised tie
- **Qualified use:** Define the institution precisely before explaining its change.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - THE JAJMANI EXCHANGE

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - The jajmani exchange

|

v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION • The jajmani exchange • Evidence chain • Qualified use • The defining feature • Jajmani

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The defining feature is the hereditary personalised tie, not the payment medium.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Jajmani system - Hereditary personalised tie Qualified use: Define the institution precisely before explaining its change.

SESSION 2 - FOUNDATION - WHY JAJMANI CHANGED

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Evidence chain: Jajmani decline mechanism - Residual service ties Qualified use: Answer an explain directive with a mechanism and a residual.

Technical definition: Technically, FOUNDATION - Why jajmani changed is analysed by relating FOUNDATION to Why jajmani changed, then testing the relationship through Evidence chain and Qualified use.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Jajmani decline mechanism - Residual service ties Qualified use: Answer an explain directive with a mechanism and a residual.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- FOUNDATION
- Why jajmani changed
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Ritual
- Change

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define Why jajmani changed, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Ritual for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

WHY JAJMANI CHANGED

01. Jajmani decline mechanism

|

v

02. Residual service ties

BOUNDARY -> Change is monetisation and transformation, not proven universal disappearance.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on.
- Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Change is monetisation and transformation, not proven universal disappearance.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Why jajmani changed.
- **Mains:** Answer an explain directive with a mechanism and a residual.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Jajmani decline mechanism -> Residual service ties
- **Qualified use:** Answer an explain directive with a mechanism and a residual.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - WHY JAJMANI CHANGED

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - Why jajmani changed

|

v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION • Why jajmani changed • Evidence chain • Qualified use • Ritual • Change

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mains: Answer an explain directive with a mechanism and a residual.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Change is monetisation and transformation, not proven universal disappearance.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Jajmani decline mechanism - Residual service ties
Qualified use: Answer an explain directive with a mechanism and a residual.

SESSION 3 - FOUNDATION - AGRARIAN CLASS STRUCTURE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Class position often correlates with caste but is not identical to it.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Agrarian class structure Qualified use: Establish the stratification baseline for any rural argument.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Agrarian class structure Qualified use: Establish the stratification baseline for any rural argument.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **FOUNDATION**
- **Agrarian class structure**
- **Evidence chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **Rural society**
- **Rural**

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define Agrarian class structure, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Rural society for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

AGRARIAN CLASS STRUCTURE

01. Agrarian class structure

BOUNDARY -> Class position often correlates with caste but is not identical to it.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Class position often correlates with caste but is not identical to it.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Agrarian class structure.
- **Mains:** Establish the stratification baseline for any rural argument.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Agrarian class structure
- **Qualified use:** Establish the stratification baseline for any rural argument.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - AGRARIAN CLASS STRUCTURE

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - Agrarian class structure

|

v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION · Agrarian class structure · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Rural society
· Rural

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Class position often correlates with caste but is not identical to it.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: establish the stratification baseline for any rural argument.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Agrarian class structure Qualified use: Establish the stratification baseline for any rural argument.

SESSION 4 - CORE - CASTE AND CLASS IN THE VILLAGE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Caste-class overlap in the village Qualified use: Handle a caste-class question without collapsing one into the other.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Caste
- class in the village
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Landownership
- The overlap

How to use them: Frame the answer through Caste; define class in the village, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Landownership for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

CASTE AND CLASS IN THE VILLAGE

01. Caste-class overlap in the village

BOUNDARY -> The overlap is loosening unevenly and has not been eliminated.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- The overlap is loosening unevenly and has not been eliminated.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Caste and class in the village.
- **Mains:** Handle a caste-class question without collapsing one into the other.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Caste-class overlap in the village
- **Qualified use:** Handle a caste-class question without collapsing one into the other.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - CASTE AND CLASS IN THE VILLAGE

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Caste and class in the village

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Caste · class in the village · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Landownership · The overlap

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Caste-class overlap in the village Qualified use: Handle a caste-class question without collapsing one into the other.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The overlap is loosening unevenly and has not been eliminated.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm...

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it.

SESSION 5 - CORE - THE DOMINANT CASTE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Evidence chain: Dominant caste Qualified use: Supply the named concept every village-power answer needs.

Technical definition: Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Dominant caste Qualified use: Supply the named concept every village-power answer needs.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- The dominant caste
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Srinivas's
- Dominant
- Qualified

How to use them: Frame the answer through The dominant caste; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with Srinivas's to explain the mechanism, and use Dominant for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

THE DOMINANT CASTE

01. Dominant caste

BOUNDARY -> Dominance rests on numbers, land and office rather than on ritual rank.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Dominance rests on numbers, land and office rather than on ritual rank.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to The dominant caste.
- **Mains:** Supply the named concept every village-power answer needs.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Dominant caste
- **Qualified use:** Supply the named concept every village-power answer needs.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - THE DOMINANT CASTE

START / CONCEPT: CORE - The dominant caste

|

v

EXACT TERMS: The dominant caste • Evidence chain • Qualified use • Srinivas's • Dominant • Qualified

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The resulting consequence is that supply the named concept every village-power answer needs.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: supply the named concept every village-power answer needs.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Dominant caste Qualified use: Supply the named concept every village-power answer needs.

SESSION 6 - CORE - SRINIVAS'S VILLAGE EVIDENCE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Rampura evidence Qualified use: Attach a named scholar and site to the power argument.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Srinivas's village evidence
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Srinivas
- Rampura
- Karnataka

How to use them: Frame the answer through Srinivas's village evidence; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with Srinivas to explain the mechanism, and use Rampura for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

SRINIVAS'S VILLAGE EVIDENCE

01. Rampura evidence

BOUNDARY -> The concept comes from located fieldwork and must be attributed accurately.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- The concept comes from located fieldwork and must be attributed accurately.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Srinivas's village evidence.
- **Mains:** Attach a named scholar and site to the power argument.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Rampura evidence
- **Qualified use:** Attach a named scholar and site to the power argument.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - SRINIVAS'S VILLAGE EVIDENCE

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Srinivas's village evidence

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Srinivas's village evidence · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Srinivas · Rampura · Karnataka

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Rampura evidence Qualified use: Attach a named scholar and site to the power argument.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The concept comes from located fieldwork and must be attributed accurately.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same...

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract.

SESSION 7 - CORE - DOMINANCE IS NOT LANDOWNERSHIP ALONE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Caste-level dominance and economic class are different categories.

Technical definition: Prelims: Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Dominance is not landownership alone.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Prelims: Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Dominance is not landownership alone.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Dominance is not landownership alone
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Dominant caste
- Dominant
- Caste-level dominance and economic class

How to use them: Frame the answer through Dominance is not landownership alone; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with Dominant caste to explain the mechanism, and use Dominant for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

DOMINANCE IS NOT LANDOWNERSHIP ALONE

01. Dominant caste is not the landowning class

BOUNDARY -> Caste-level dominance and economic class are different categories.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Caste-level dominance and economic class are different categories.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Dominance is not landownership alone.
- **Mains:** Prevent a category error that examiners specifically test.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Dominant caste is not the landowning class
- **Qualified use:** Prevent a category error that examiners specifically test.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - DOMINANCE IS NOT LANDOWNERSHIP ALONE

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Dominance is not landownership alone

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Dominance is not landownership alone • Evidence chain • Qualified use • Dominant caste
• Dominant • Caste-level dominance and economic class

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Dominant caste is not the landowning class Qualified use:
Prevent a category error that examiners specifically test.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office,
while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are
usually but not necessarily coextensive.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: caste-level dominance and economic
class are different categories.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Prelims: Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category,
dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Dominance is not landownership alone.

SESSION 8 - CORE - GREEN REVOLUTION DIFFERENTIATION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Evidence chain: Green Revolution differentiation Qualified use: Turn an output story into a distribution argument.

Technical definition: Capital requirements explain differentiation better than technology alone.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Green Revolution differentiation Qualified use: Turn an output story into a distribution argument.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Green Revolution differentiation
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- High-yielding-variety
- Capital
- Green Revolution

How to use them: Frame the answer through Green Revolution differentiation; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with High-yielding-variety to explain the mechanism, and use Capital for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

GREEN REVOLUTION DIFFERENTIATION

01. Green Revolution differentiation

BOUNDARY -> Capital requirements explain differentiation better than technology alone.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Capital requirements explain differentiation better than technology alone.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Green Revolution differentiation.
- **Mains:** Turn an output story into a distribution argument.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Green Revolution differentiation
- **Qualified use:** Turn an output story into a distribution argument.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - GREEN REVOLUTION DIFFERENTIATION

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Green Revolution differentiation

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Green Revolution differentiation · Evidence chain · Qualified use · High-yielding-variety · Capital · Green Revolution

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Capital requirements explain differentiation better than technology alone.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: turn an output story into a distribution argument.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Green Revolution differentiation Qualified use: Turn an output story into a distribution argument.

SESSION 9 - CORE - WHY THE OUTCOME IS REGION-SPECIFIC

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Prelims: Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Why the outcome is region-specific.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Region-specific outcome Qualified use: Add the qualification that protects a critical directive.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Prelims: Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Why the outcome is region-specific.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Why the outcome is region-specific
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Retain
- Why
- Region-specific

How to use them: Frame the answer through Why the outcome is region-specific; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with Retain to explain the mechanism, and use Why for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

WHY THE OUTCOME IS REGION-SPECIFIC

01. Region-specific outcome

BOUNDARY -> Crop, tenancy, irrigation and price support make one universal outcome indefensible.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Crop, tenancy, irrigation and price support make one universal outcome indefensible.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Why the outcome is region-specific.
- **Mains:** Add the qualification that protects a critical directive.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Region-specific outcome
- **Qualified use:** Add the qualification that protects a critical directive.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - WHY THE OUTCOME IS REGION-SPECIFIC

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Why the outcome is region-specific

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Why the outcome is region-specific • Evidence chain • Qualified use • Retain • Why • Region-specific

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Region-specific outcome Qualified use: Add the qualification that protects a critical directive.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The resulting consequence is that retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached...

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached...

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Prelims: Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Why the outcome is region-specific.

SESSION 10 - CORE - PANCHAYATI RAJ RESERVATION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Evidence chain: Panchayati Raj reservation Qualified use: Introduce formal contestation of inherited village authority.

Technical definition: Institutional design belongs to Governance and is cross-linked, not restated.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Panchayati Raj reservation Qualified use: Introduce formal contestation of inherited village authority.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Panchayati Raj reservation
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Institutional design belongs to Governance and
- Institutional
- Governance

How to use them: Frame the answer through Panchayati Raj reservation; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with Institutional design belongs to Governance and to explain the mechanism, and use Institutional for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

PANCHAYATI RAJ RESERVATION

01. Panchayati Raj reservation

BOUNDARY -> Institutional design belongs to Governance and is cross-linked, not restated.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Institutional design belongs to Governance and is cross-linked, not restated.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Panchayati Raj reservation.
- **Mains:** Introduce formal contestation of inherited village authority.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Panchayati Raj reservation
- **Qualified use:** Introduce formal contestation of inherited village authority.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - PANCHAYATI RAJ RESERVATION

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Panchayati Raj reservation

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Panchayati Raj reservation · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Institutional design belongs to Governance and · Institutional · Governance

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Institutional design belongs to Governance and is cross-linked, not restated.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The resulting consequence is that institutional design belongs to Governance and is cross-linked, not restated.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: institutional design belongs to Governance and is cross-linked, not restated.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Panchayati Raj reservation Qualified use: Introduce formal contestation of inherited village authority.

SESSION 11 - CORE - REPRESENTATION AND SUBSTANTIVE POWER

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Formal inclusion and agenda-setting power are separate questions.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Formal representation versus substantive power Qualified use: Convert a policy statement into a social-power assessment.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Representation
- substantive power
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Formal
- Formal inclusion and agenda-setting power

How to use them: Frame the answer through Representation; define substantive power, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Formal for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

REPRESENTATION AND SUBSTANTIVE POWER

01. Formal representation versus substantive power

BOUNDARY -> Formal inclusion and agenda-setting power are separate questions.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Formal inclusion and agenda-setting power are separate questions.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Representation and substantive power.
- **Mains:** Convert a policy statement into a social-power assessment.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Formal representation versus substantive power
- **Qualified use:** Convert a policy statement into a social-power assessment.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - REPRESENTATION AND SUBSTANTIVE POWER

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Representation and substantive power

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Representation • substantive power • Evidence chain • Qualified use • Formal • Formal inclusion and agenda-setting power

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Formal representation versus substantive power Qualified use: Convert a policy statement into a social-power assessment.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Formal inclusion and agenda-setting power are separate questions.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks...

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy.

SESSION 12 - CORE - THE RURAL-URBAN CONTINUUM

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Evidence chain: Rural-urban continuum - Continuum in practice Qualified use: Replace a traditional-modern binary with a defensible model.

Technical definition: The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Rural-urban continuum - Continuum in practice Qualified use: Replace a traditional-modern binary with a defensible model.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- The rural-urban continuum
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Continuity
- Rural-urban
- Continuum

How to use them: Frame the answer through The rural-urban continuum; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with Continuity to explain the mechanism, and use Rural-urban for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

THE RURAL-URBAN CONTINUUM

01. Rural-urban continuum

|

v

02. Continuum in practice

BOUNDARY -> Continuity of linkage does not deny that remoteness and land relations still matter.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types.
- Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Continuity of linkage does not deny that remoteness and land relations still matter.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to The rural-urban continuum.
- **Mains:** Replace a traditional-modern binary with a defensible model.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Rural-urban continuum -> Continuum in practice
- **Qualified use:** Replace a traditional-modern binary with a defensible model.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - THE RURAL-URBAN CONTINUUM

START / CONCEPT: CORE - The rural-urban continuum

|

v

EXACT TERMS: The rural-urban continuum · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Continuity · Rural-urban · Continuum

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Continuity of linkage does not deny that remoteness and land relations still matter.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: the continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by...

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Rural-urban continuum - Continuum in practice
Qualified use: Replace a traditional-modern binary with a defensible model.

SESSION 13 - CORE SYNTHESIS - SCOPE DISCIPLINE IN A RURAL ANSWER

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Evidence chain: Scope discipline on land law Qualified use: Protect a Society answer from becoming an Economy answer.

Technical definition: Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Scope discipline on land law Qualified use: Protect a Society answer from becoming an Economy answer.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- CORE SYNTHESIS
- Scope discipline in a rural answer
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Land-ceiling
- Economy

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define Scope discipline in a rural answer, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Land-ceiling for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

SCOPE DISCIPLINE IN A RURAL ANSWER

01. Scope discipline on land law

BOUNDARY -> Land law and institutional design belong to other owners and are cross-referred.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Land law and institutional design belong to other owners and are cross-referred.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Scope discipline in a rural answer.
- **Mains:** Protect a Society answer from becoming an Economy answer.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Scope discipline on land law
- **Qualified use:** Protect a Society answer from becoming an Economy answer.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - SCOPE DISCIPLINE IN A RURAL ANSWER

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - Scope discipline in a rural answer

|

v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · Scope discipline in a rural answer · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Land-ceiling · Economy

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Land law and institutional design belong to other owners and are cross-referred.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati...

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Scope discipline on land law Qualified use: Protect a Society answer from becoming an Economy answer.

SESSION 14 - CORE SYNTHESIS - MEASUREMENT BOUNDARIES

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Evidence chain: Periodic Labour Force Survey boundary - Employment data cannot prove village power Qualified use: State what the available data can and cannot prove.

Technical definition: Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Periodic Labour Force Survey boundary - Employment data cannot prove village power Qualified use: State what the available data can and cannot prove.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- CORE SYNTHESIS
- Measurement boundaries
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24
- 2023-24

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define Measurement boundaries, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

MEASUREMENT BOUNDARIES

01. Periodic Labour Force Survey boundary

|
v

02. Employment data cannot prove village power

BOUNDARY -> A labour indicator cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle.
- Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- A labour indicator cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Measurement boundaries.
- **Mains:** State what the available data can and cannot prove.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Periodic Labour Force Survey boundary -> Employment data cannot prove village power
- **Qualified use:** State what the available data can and cannot prove.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - MEASUREMENT BOUNDARIES

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - Measurement boundaries

|
v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS • Measurement boundaries • Evidence chain • Qualified use • Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 • 2023-24

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Mains: State what the available data can and cannot prove.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Periodic Labour Force Survey boundary - Employment data cannot prove village power Qualified use: State what the available data can and cannot prove.

SESSION 15 - CORE SYNTHESIS - ANSWER SPINE AND HONEST QUESTION STATUS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Evidence chain: Which resource now carries power - Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status
Qualified use: Assemble the rural answer spine around the resource that carries power.

Technical definition: Technically, CORE SYNTHESIS - Answer spine and honest question status is analysed by relating CORE SYNTHESIS to spine, then testing the relationship through honest question status and Evidence chain.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Which resource now carries power - Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status
Qualified use: Assemble the rural answer spine around the resource that carries power.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- CORE SYNTHESIS
- spine
- honest question status
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Subject

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define spine, connect honest question status with Evidence chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

ANSWER SPINE AND HONEST QUESTION STATUS

01. Which resource now carries power

|
v

02. Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status

BOUNDARY -> The absence of a direct recent question is recorded honestly rather than filled by invention.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village.
- No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- The absence of a direct recent question is recorded honestly rather than filled by invention.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Answer spine and honest question status.
- **Mains:** Assemble the rural answer spine around the resource that carries power.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Which resource now carries power -> Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status
- **Qualified use:** Assemble the rural answer spine around the resource that carries power.

COMPLETE BASIC OWNER EVIDENCE BANK

Subject: Indian Society | **Tier:** Must-Do (foundation) | **GS Paper:** GS-I. **Core area:** Jajmani system, agrarian class structure, dominant caste in village power, and the rural-urban continuum. **Grounded in:** M.N. Srinivas's village-study sociology (dominant caste, rural power); MoSPI PLFS 2023-24 rural-workforce data and PLFS Annual Report 2025; no direct 2024/2025 GS-I PYQ (older-pattern recurring theme, not fabricated). **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = analytical inference | **CURRENT:** = current anchor. *Companion:* advanced/05_Rural-Society-and-Agrarian-Change.md.

1. Visual foundation

TRADITIONAL VILLAGE ECONOMY
|
v
JAJMANI SYSTEM (historical)
Patron households (jajman, usually landholding)
|
v
Hereditary service groups (kamin: barber, washerman, priest, carpenter, blacksmith) received customary payments, often grain/kind and sometimes cash
|
v
AGRARIAN CLASS STRUCTURE
Landowner - Tenant/sharecropper - Landless labourer
|
v
DOMINANT CASTE
(numbers + land + political office converge in village-level power, not always ritual rank)
|
v
RURAL-URBAN CONTINUUM
(villages increasingly linked to towns via migration, remittance, markets, media - not a sealed traditional/modern divide)

Core proposition: ANALYSIS: Jajmani was an important but regionally variable historical patron-client arrangement, alongside caste-linked agrarian hierarchy. Locally dominant castes can convert numbers, land and office into power; migration, markets and Panchayati Raj have reworked rather than uniformly eliminated caste-class overlap, making a rural-urban continuum more useful than a strict traditional/modern divide.

2. Essential definitions

Concept	Exam-ready meaning
FACT: Jajmani system	A historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households (jajman) received customary services from designated groups (kamin). Payments were often grain or kind, but cash and local variation existed; it was not one uniform all-India institution.
FACT: Agrarian class structure	The stratification of rural society into landowning cultivators, tenants/sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, often (though not always) correlating with caste position.
FACT: Dominant caste (M.N. Srinivas)	A caste that is numerically strong, holds a significant share of local land and exercises political influence in a village or region, whether or not it is ritually highest-ranked.
ANALYSIS: Rural-urban continuum	The sociological view that villages and towns are linked by migration, remittance, trade and communication rather than separated by a rigid traditional-modern divide.
ANALYSIS: Caste-class overlap in agrarian structure	The empirical tendency for landownership and caste rank to coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening this correlation.

3. How rural society and agrarian structure work

- Jajmani exchange logic:** FACT: patron households secured routine services (haircuts, laundry, ritual officiating, tool-making) from designated service castes in exchange for a fixed share of the harvest or customary payment in kind, embedding caste occupation into the village economy.
- Change in jajmani relations:** ANALYSIS: cash-wage labour, non-farm employment, urban migration and weaker caste-occupation linkage have altered or eroded many customary service relations, though ritual and personalised service ties persist in some places.
- Agrarian class stratification:** FACT: ownership of land, security of tenancy and dependence on wage labour differentiate rural households; land reform, land ceiling laws and their macro-economic mechanics are Economy's territory, not elaborated here.
- Dominant caste as village power:** FACT: Srinivas's fieldwork showed that a caste combining numerical strength, landholding and political office could dominate a village's decision-making regardless of its ritual rank, making it the practical unit of local power analysis.
- Green Revolution's social effect:** ANALYSIS: initial gains often favoured irrigated regions and cultivators able to access inputs, credit and markets, which could sharpen class differentiation and reinforce dominant-caste advantage. Adoption and distribution varied by crop, tenancy and region; do not make this a universal outcome.
- Panchayati Raj's restructuring effect:** ANALYSIS: reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats have introduced new, formally mandated voices into village governance, contesting (without eliminating) older dominant-caste control.
- Rural-urban continuum in practice:** ANALYSIS: remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road/market access mean most villages today are continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life, not isolated traditional units.

4. Institutions and concepts

- FACT: **Jajmani (kamin-jajman relationship):** a historical service-exchange institution whose form, payment and persistence varied across regions; cash-wage and market relations have changed many such ties.
- FACT: **Dominant caste:** the numbers-land-power convergence concept central to understanding

village-level authority.

- ANALYSIS: **Village Panchayat as contested arena:** Panchayati Raj institutions are where dominant-caste authority and newly mandated reserved representation now interact; the institutional design of Panchayati Raj itself is Governance's territory.

- ANALYSIS: **Land reform and tenancy law (cross-linked, not restated):** land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics belong to Economy/basic/23_Poverty-Inequality-Social-Sector-and-Inclusive-Growth.md and related Economy files.

5. Indian applications and examples

- ANALYSIS: A village where the locally numerous, landholding middle caste controls the Panchayat Pradhan's office despite not being the ritually highest caste illustrates the dominant-caste concept directly.

- ANALYSIS: A family that once received grain payment for traditional barbering services from a patron household, but now works for daily cash wages in a nearby town, illustrates the jajmani system's decline and the rural-urban continuum simultaneously.

- ANALYSIS: No direct 2024/2025 GS-I Mains PYQ specifically targets rural society/agrarian change; this is a recurring, older-pattern examination theme rather than a currently PYQ-anchored one - this is stated honestly rather than inventing a fabricated recent question.

6. Must-Know Facts for Prelims

- FACT: M.N. Srinivas coined "dominant caste" from his Rampura (Karnataka) village fieldwork, the same study that produced "Sanskritisation."

- FACT: Jajmani relationships were often hereditary and involved customary grain/in-kind payments, but local records also show cash and mixed forms; avoid treating "no cash" as a universal definition.

- FACT: Panchayati Raj mandates reservation for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in local bodies (institutional design is Governance's territory).

- CURRENT: PLFS 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator; PLFS Annual Report 2025, released March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December period.

- ANALYSIS: Rural-urban continuum theory rejects a strict traditional/modern binary in favour of continuous, ongoing linkage between villages and towns.

7. UPSC traps

- WRONG: Jajmani system payments were always cash wages / never cash. -> Customary grain or in-kind payment was common, but arrangements varied and could include cash. Its key difference from a modern labour market is the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie.

- WRONG: Dominant caste always means the ritually highest-ranked caste in a village. -> Dominance rests on numbers, land and political power, which can belong to a middle-ranked but locally numerous and land-owning caste.

- WRONG: Land reform has ended caste-class overlap in Indian villages. -> Overlap has loosened in many regions through tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income, but has not been eliminated; regional variation is substantial.

- WRONG: Villages are isolated, self-contained traditional units untouched by urban India. -> The rural-urban continuum concept explicitly rejects this, citing migration, remittance, media and market linkage as continuous connectors.

8. CURRENT: Current anchor

- CURRENT: PLFS 2023-24 remains a dated rural-employment comparator. The **PLFS Annual Report

2025**, released March 2026, is the latest annual round; it uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. Cite the period and exact rural indicator before comparing rounds.

9. PYQ application

- ANALYSIS: No direct 2024/2025 GS-I Mains PYQ targets this topic specifically; when constructing an answer on rural society, anchor it instead to the jajmani-decline and dominant-caste concepts, which remain the syllabus's core testable content for this theme.

10. Mains angles

- ANALYSIS: Use changing jajmani relations and dominant-caste persistence as complementary, not contradictory, observations - but qualify both by regional variation and avoid claiming either has disappeared everywhere.

- ANALYSIS: Cross-link land-reform and tenancy-law mechanics to Economy rather than re-deriving them.

- ANALYSIS: Use the rural-urban continuum framing to avoid treating villages as static or isolated.

Answer thesis: Rural India contains regionally varied, changing jajmani and caste-class arrangements. Cash work, non-farm employment and migration have altered many personalised service ties, while dominant-caste power can persist or be challenged through land, electoral institutions and reservations; a rural-urban continuum, not a rigid traditional/modern divide, best captures these uneven connections.

11. Probable questions

- ANALYSIS: **Prelims:** What form of payment was characteristic of the traditional jajmani system?

- ANALYSIS: **Mains (10 marks):** Explain the jajmani system and account for its decline in contemporary rural India.

- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks):** Examine the concept of "dominant caste" and its relevance to understanding power structures in Indian villages today.

- ANALYSIS: **Mains (10 marks):** What is meant by the "rural-urban continuum"? Illustrate with Indian examples.

12. Study links

- FACT: Advanced companion: [advanced/05_Rural-Society-and-Agrarian-Change.md](#).

- FACT: [02_Caste-System-Structure-and-Contemporary-Dynamics.md](#) - dominant caste as a general caste-mobility concept (do not re-derive here).

- FACT: [Economy/basic/23_Poverty-Inequality-Social-Sector-and-Inclusive-Growth.md](#) - land reform, tenancy law and macro poverty data.

- FACT: [Governance/basic/04_NGOs-SHGs-and-Civil-Society-Stakeholders.md](#) - Panchayati Raj institutional design and rural social capital.

- FACT: [10_Urbanisation-Problems-and-Remedies.md](#) - the urban side of the rural-urban continuum.

13. Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

Core-only. Rural answers must explain a changing power relation, not romanticise a village or substitute land-law detail for social analysis.

13.1 Directive-to-structure map

Demand family	What is tested	Structure that scores
Explain jajmani decline	Historical institution plus change mechanism	define -> exchange logic -> monetisation/migration -> residual ties
Examine dominant caste	Power rather than ritual rank	numbers + land + office -> contestation -> qualification
Assess agrarian change	Distribution, not output alone	land/class structure -> Green Revolution differentiation -> non-farm/migration -> verdict
Critically examine Panchayat change	Formal representation versus substantive voice	reserved seat -> informal power -> conditions for agency
Compare rural and urban	Continuum, not binary	flows of labour/remittance/media -> what remains locally specific

13.2 Thesis bank

- **T1: ANALYSIS:** Agrarian change has restructured caste-class power more often than it has dissolved it.
- **T2: ANALYSIS:** Village power is better predicted by the convergence of numbers, land and office than by ritual rank alone.
- **T3: ANALYSIS:** The rural-urban continuum changes rural society through migration and markets while leaving uneven land, labour and care relations locally consequential.

13.3 Mark-scaled spines

10 marks - explain the decline of jajmani. Define its hereditary, personalised patron-service relation; use cash wages, non-farm work and migration as mechanisms of change; retain ritual/personalised residual ties as qualification; conclude with monetisation, not disappearance.

15 marks - dominant caste and village power. Begin with T2. Apply **M.N. Srinivas's** numbers-land-office test, distinguish it from landowning class and ritual superiority, then evaluate Panchayat reservation as formal contestation. Close with the representation-versus-power caveat.

20 marks - "Rural India is connected to markets yet remains socially stratified." Assess. Combine agrarian class, Green Revolution differentiation, rural non-farm work, migration/remittances and Panchayat politics. Add one continuum diagram and a paragraph on regional/tenancy variation; route land-reform mechanics to Economy.

13.4 Evidence bank - claim -> named evidence/example -> significance -> limitation

- **E1 - Village power.** *Claim:* local power need not follow ritual rank. *Evidence:* **M.N. Srinivas's dominant-caste concept**, developed through **Rampura** village study. *Significance:* gives a named lens for numbers, land and political office. *Limitation:* dominance varies by locality and does not prove every member is affluent.
- **E2 - Jajmani transformation.** *Claim:* caste-linked service exchange can be displaced by a labour market. *Evidence:* **jajman-kamin** relation-customary service/payment, often grain or kind and sometimes cash-contrasted with daily cash wage work. *Significance:* identifies the mechanism rather than merely listing occupations. *Limitation:* regional variation and ritual-service survival preclude a total-decline claim.
- **E3 - Differentiated growth.** *Claim:* productivity gains can be unequally distributed. *Evidence:* the **Green Revolution** required irrigation, inputs, credit and market access. *Significance:* supports a class-differentiation argument. *Limitation:* do not infer one outcome for every crop, tenancy regime or region.
- **E4 - Representation gap.** *Claim:* reserved representation can contest inherited power but cannot alone prove agency. *Evidence:* **Panchayati Raj** SC/ST/women reservation. *Significance:* turns a policy statement into a social-power question. *Limitation:* institutional rules belong to Governance; proxy control or independent leadership must be established locally.

- **E5 - Measurement caution.** *Claim:* employment data is not a village-power measure.

Evidence: **PLFS Annual Report 2025** uses a January-December reference period. *Significance:* it can contextualise rural labour change. *Limitation:* it cannot prove jajmani decline or caste dominance.

13.5 Balance bank and verdict scaffolds

- **ANALYSIS:** Reject both the timeless “village republic” and the claim that market change erased hierarchy.
- **ANALYSIS:** Separate formal reserved representation from substantive agenda-setting.
- **ANALYSIS:** Use a rural-urban continuum without denying that remoteness and land relations matter.
- **Verdict:** “The relevant question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged, but which resource-land, office, network or non-farm income-now carries it.”

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - ANSWER SPINE AND HONEST QUESTION STATUS

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - Answer spine and honest question status
 |
 v
 EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · spine · honest question status · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Subject
 |
 v
 MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The absence of a direct recent question is recorded honestly rather than filled by invention.
 |
 v
 CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village.
 |
 v
 UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Core proposition: ANALYSIS: Jajmani was an important but regionally variable historical patron-client arrangement, alongside caste-linked agrarian hierarchy.
 |
 v
 ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Which resource now carries power - Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status Qualified use: Assemble the rural answer spine around the resource that carries power.

INDIAN SOCIETY DEEP-REVIEW CORE CONTROL

- **Must remember:** Rural society combines caste, class, land, labour, credit, kinship, panchayat, market and state relations; agrarian change follows tenure reform, Green Revolution, mechanisation, commercialisation, feminisation, migration, non-farm diversification and ecological stress.
- **Close distinction:** Rural is not agricultural, landowner is not cultivator, farmer is not only title-holder, productivity is not income, agricultural labour is not bonded labour, and Panchayati Raj representation is not the same as effective decision-making power.
- **Evidence / interpretation limit:** Contrast Punjab-Haryana, eastern India, dryland Deccan, plantation, tribal and peri-urban regions; use Agriculture Census, Situation Assessment and labour data with period/coverage labels, and treat technology-policy correlations as mechanisms requiring land, water, market and power analysis.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Jajmani system?

A. The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash. B. Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. C. Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival. D. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test.

Answer: A. Explanation: The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under Jajmani system?

A. Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival. B. The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash. C. Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. D. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position.

Answer: B. Explanation: The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Jajmani system?

A. Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. B. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. C. The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash. D. Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival.

Answer: C. Explanation: The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Jajmani system?

A. Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. B. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. C. M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis. D. The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash.

Answer: D. Explanation: The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Hereditary personalised tie?

A. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. B. Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. C. Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival. D. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position.

Answer: A. Explanation: What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under Hereditary personalised tie?

A. Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. B. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. C. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. D. Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival.

Answer: B. Explanation: What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Hereditary personalised tie?

A. M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis. B. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. C. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. D. Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it.

Answer: C. Explanation: What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Hereditary personalised tie?

A. Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. B. M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis. C. Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract. D. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test.

Answer: D. Explanation: What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Jajmani decline mechanism?

A. Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. B. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. C. Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. D. Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival.

Answer: A. Explanation: Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Jajmani decline mechanism?

A. Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. B. Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. C. M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis. D. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position.

Answer: B. Explanation: Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Jajmani decline mechanism?

A. Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. B. Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract. C. Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. D. M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis.

Answer: C. Explanation: Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Jajmani decline mechanism?

A. Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. B. M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis. C. Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract. D. Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on.

Answer: D. Explanation: Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Residual service ties?

A. Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival. B. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. C. Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. D. M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis.

Answer: A. Explanation: Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under Residual service ties?

A. Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract. B. Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival. C. Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. D. M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis.

Answer: B. Explanation: Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Residual service ties?

A. M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis. B. Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. C. Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival. D. Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract.

Answer: C. Explanation: Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Residual service ties?

A. High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. B. Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract. C. Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. D. Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival.

Answer: D. Explanation: Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Agrarian class structure?

A. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. B. M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis. C. Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract. D. Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it.

Answer: A. Explanation: Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under Agrarian class structure?

A. Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract. B. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. C. Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. D. M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis.

Answer: B. Explanation: Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Agrarian class structure?

A. High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. B. Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. C. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. D. Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract.

Answer: C. Explanation: Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Agrarian class structure?

A. High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. B. Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. C. Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. D. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position.

Answer: D. Explanation: Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Caste-class overlap in the village?

A. Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. B. Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. C. Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract. D. M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis.

Answer: A. Explanation: Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Caste-class overlap in the village?

A. High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. B. Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. C. Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. D. Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract.

Answer: B. Explanation: Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Caste-class overlap in the village?

A. Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. B. High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. C. Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. D. Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result.

Answer: C. Explanation: Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Caste-class overlap in the village?

A. Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. B. High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. C. Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control. D. Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it.

Answer: D. Explanation: Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Dominant caste?

A. M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis. B. Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. C. High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. D. Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract.

Answer: A. Explanation: M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under Dominant caste?

A. Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. B. M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis. C. High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. D. Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive.

Answer: B. Explanation: M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Dominant caste?

A. High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. B. Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. C. M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis. D. Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control.

Answer: C. Explanation: M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Dominant caste?

A. Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. B. Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. C. Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control. D. M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis.

Answer: D. Explanation: M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Rampura evidence?

A. Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract. B. Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. C. Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. D. High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains.

Answer: A. Explanation: Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under Rampura evidence?

A. Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control. B. Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract. C. Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. D. High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains.

Answer: B. Explanation: Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Rampura evidence?

- A. Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. B. Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. C. Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract. D. Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control.

Answer: C. Explanation: Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Rampura evidence?

- A. The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. B. Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control. C. Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. D. Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract.

Answer: D. Explanation: Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Dominant caste is not the landowning class?

- A. Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. B. Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. C. Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control. D. High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains.

Answer: A. Explanation: Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under Dominant caste is not the landowning class?

- A. Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control. B. Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. C. Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. D. Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result.

Answer: B. Explanation: Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not

necessarily coextensive. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Dominant caste is not the landowning class?

A. Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. B. The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. C. Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. D. Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control.

Answer: C. Explanation: Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Dominant caste is not the landowning class?

A. The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. B. Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. C. Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. D. Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive.

Answer: D. Explanation: Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Green Revolution differentiation?

A. High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. B. Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. C. Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. D. Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control.

Answer: A. Explanation: High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under Green Revolution differentiation?

A. Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control. B. High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. C. The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. D. Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy.

Answer: B. Explanation: High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Green Revolution differentiation?

A. Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. B. Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. C. High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. D. The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types.

Answer: C. Explanation: High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Green Revolution differentiation?

A. The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. B. Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. C. Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them. D. High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains.

Answer: D. Explanation: High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Region-specific outcome?

A. Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. B. Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control. C. The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. D. Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy.

Answer: A. Explanation: Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under Region-specific outcome?

A. The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. B. Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. C. Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. D. Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it.

Answer: B. Explanation: Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Region-specific outcome?

A. Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them. B. Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. C. Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. D. The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types.

Answer: C. Explanation: Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Region-specific outcome?

A. Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. B. Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them. C. Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. D. Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result.

Answer: D. Explanation: Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Panchayati Raj reservation?

A. Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control. B. The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. C. Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. D. Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it.

Answer: A. Explanation: Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Panchayati Raj reservation?

A. The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. B. Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control. C. Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. D. Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them.

Answer: B. Explanation: Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Panchayati Raj reservation?

A. Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. B. Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. C. Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control. D. Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them.

Answer: C. Explanation: Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Panchayati Raj reservation?

A. Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. B. Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. C. Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them. D. Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control.

Answer: D. Explanation: Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Formal representation versus substantive power?

A. Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. B. Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them. C. The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. D. Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it.

Answer: A. Explanation: Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under Formal representation versus substantive power?

A. Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. B. Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. C. Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. D. Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them.

Answer: B. Explanation: Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Formal representation versus substantive power?

A. Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. B. Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. C. Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. D. Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them.

Answer: C. Explanation: Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Formal representation versus substantive power?

A. Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. B. Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. C. The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. D. Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy.

Answer: D. Explanation: Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Rural-urban continuum?

A. The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. B. Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. C. Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. D. Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them.

Answer: A. Explanation: The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under Rural-urban continuum?

A. Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. B. The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. C. Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. D. Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them.

Answer: B. Explanation: The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Rural-urban continuum?

A. Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. B. Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. C. The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. D. The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village.

Answer: C. Explanation: The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Rural-urban continuum?

A. The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. B. No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands. C. Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. D. The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types.

Answer: D. Explanation: The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Continuum in practice?

A. Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. B. Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. C. Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them. D. Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle.

Answer: A. Explanation: Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Continuum in practice?

A. Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. B. Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. C. Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. D. The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village.

Answer: B. Explanation: Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Continuum in practice?

A. No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands. B. The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. C. Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. D. Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator.

Answer: C. Explanation: Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Continuum in practice?

A. The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. B. No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands. C. The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash. D. Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously

linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it.

Answer: D. Explanation: Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Scope discipline on land law?

A. Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them. B. Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. C. Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. D. The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village.

Answer: A. Explanation: Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under Scope discipline on land law?

A. The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. B. Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them. C. Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. D. No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands.

Answer: B. Explanation: Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Scope discipline on land law?

A. The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. B. No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands. C. Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them. D. The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash.

Answer: C. Explanation: Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Scope discipline on land law?

A. The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash. B. No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands. C. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. D. Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them.

Answer: D. Explanation: Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Periodic Labour Force Survey boundary?

A. Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. B. No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands. C. Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. D. The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village.

Answer: A. Explanation: Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Periodic Labour Force Survey boundary?

A. The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. B. Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. C. The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash. D. No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands.

Answer: B. Explanation: Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Periodic Labour Force Survey boundary?

A. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. B. No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands. C. Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. D. The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash.

Answer: C. Explanation: Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Periodic Labour Force Survey boundary?

A. Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. B. The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash. C. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. D. Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle.

Answer: D. Explanation: Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Employment data cannot prove village power?

A. Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. B. The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash. C. The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. D. No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands.

Answer: A. Explanation: Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Employment data cannot prove village power?

A. No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands. B. Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. C. The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash. D. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test.

Answer: B. Explanation: Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Employment data cannot prove village power?

A. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. B. Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. C. Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. D. The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash.

Answer: C. Explanation: Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Employment data cannot prove village power?

A. Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. B. Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival. C. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. D. Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator.

Answer: D. Explanation: Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Which resource now carries power?

A. The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. B. No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands. C. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. D. The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment

often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash.

Answer: A. Explanation: The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Which resource now carries power?

A. The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash. B. The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. C. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. D. Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on.

Answer: B. Explanation: The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Which resource now carries power?

A. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. B. Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival. C. The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. D. Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on.

Answer: C. Explanation: The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Which resource now carries power?

A. Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival. B. Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. C. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. D. The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village.

Answer: D. Explanation: The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?

A. No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands. B. The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash. C. Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. D. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test.

Answer: A. Explanation: No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?”, all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in “Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?”.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?
Analysis: Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** D. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in “Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?”.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For “Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?”, replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?

A. Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. B. No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands. C. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. D. Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival.

Answer: B. Explanation: No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?”, all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in “Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?”.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status? **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** C. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in “Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?”.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For “Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?”, replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?

A. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. B. Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival. C. No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands. D. Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on.

Answer: C. Explanation: No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Demand decoding: Treat “Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?” as a definition, category, constitutional boundary, institution, mechanism and source-date-status problem. Test each statement.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in “Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?”.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status? **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in “Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?”.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: Fix the comparison axis; separate social category from legal status, right from institution and scheme from outcome; test the closest homogenisation, causation or stale-data distractor.

Why this earns marks: It prevents a familiar label or aggregate statistic from replacing the exact concept, institutional mandate, mechanism or evidence status.

How to improve this answer: For “Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?”, state why the nearest distractor fails on definition, group variation, causation, constitutional boundary, date or status.

Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?

A. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. B. Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival. C. Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. D. No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands.

Answer: D. Explanation: No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Demand decoding: Treat “Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?” as a definition, category, constitutional boundary, institution, mechanism and source-date-status problem. Test each statement.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in “Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?”.

Analytical body:

- Claim and named evidence:** Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status? **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
- Claim and named evidence:** A. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
- Claim and named evidence:** C. Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in “Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?”.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: Fix the comparison axis; separate social category from legal status, right from institution and scheme from outcome; test the closest homogenisation, causation or stale-data distractor.

Why this earns marks: It prevents a familiar label or aggregate statistic from replacing the exact concept, institutional mandate, mechanism or evidence status.

How to improve this answer: For “Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?”, state why the nearest distractor fails on definition, group variation, causation, constitutional boundary, date or status.

TRANSPARENT ZERO-DIRECT-PYQ AUDIT

No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the audited routing ledgers or in the locally held official question papers is routed to rural society and agrarian change. This owner therefore records a transparent zero-direct-PYQ status rather than inventing a recent question, a marking scheme or an official key. The theme remains an older-pattern recurring examination area, and the six original solved Mains answers below prepare the four demand families the owner actually carries: jajmani change, dominant caste and village power, agrarian differentiation, and the rural-urban continuum. Adjacent land-reform, tenancy and poverty questions are owned by Economy and Panchayati Raj institutional design is owned by Governance, and neither is claimed here.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- ANALYSIS: No direct 2024/2025 GS-I Mains PYQ targets this topic specifically; when constructing an answer on rural society, anchor it instead to the jajmani-decline and dominant-caste concepts, which remain the syllabus's core testable content for this theme.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- ANALYSIS: No direct 2024/2025 GS-I Mains PYQ targets rural society/agrarian change specifically; this is flagged honestly rather than a fabricated question being presented as verified. When a rural-society question does appear, the expected analytical route is: define jajmani and its decline, apply the dominant-caste concept to village power, use the Green Revolution differentiation chain to explain intra-village inequality, and close with the formal-representation-versus-substantive-power gap in Panchayati Raj.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain the jajmani system and account for its transformation in contemporary rural India. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Jajmani was a hereditary, personalised patron-client exchange rather than a cash-free economy, and commercialisation, non-farm work and migration monetised it into contractual labour while leaving ritual service ties in place.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash.
- What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test.
- Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on.
- Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival.

Qualified conclusion: Jajmani was a hereditary, personalised patron-client exchange rather than a cash-free economy, and commercialisation, non-farm work and migration monetised it into contractual labour while leaving ritual service ties in place.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain the jajmani system and account for its transformation in contemporary rural India...", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Jajmani was a hereditary, personalised patron-client exchange rather than a cash-free economy, and commercialisation, non-farm work and migration monetised it into contractual labour while leaving ritual service ties in place.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Jajmani was a hereditary, personalised patron-client exchange rather than a cash-free economy, and commercialisation, non-farm work and migration monetised it into contractual labour while leaving ritual service ties in place.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise three points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "Explain the jajmani system and account for its transformation in contemporary rural India....", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: What is meant by the rural-urban continuum, and why is it preferred to a rural-urban dichotomy? Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The continuum treats villages and towns as linked points on one spectrum rather than opposed types, because migration, remittance, media and market access keep rural life continuously connected to urban life.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types.
- Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it.

- Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them.

Qualified conclusion: The continuum treats villages and towns as linked points on one spectrum rather than opposed types, because migration, remittance, media and market access keep rural life continuously connected to urban life.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “What is meant by the rural-urban continuum, and why is it preferred to a rural-urban...”, all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The continuum treats villages and towns as linked points on one spectrum rather than opposed types, because migration, remittance, media and market access keep rural life continuously connected to urban life.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The continuum treats villages and towns as linked points on one spectrum rather than opposed types, because migration, remittance, media and market access keep rural life continuously connected to urban life.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise three points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For “What is meant by the rural-urban continuum, and why is it preferred to a rural-urban...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Examine the concept of the dominant caste and its relevance to village power today. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Dominance built on numbers, land and office predicts everyday village authority better than ritual rank, and reserved Panchayat representation now contests that authority without displacing it.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis.
- Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract.
- Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive.
- Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control.
- Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy.

Qualified conclusion: Dominance built on numbers, land and office predicts everyday village authority better than ritual rank, and reserved Panchayat representation now contests that authority without displacing it.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on "Examine the concept of the dominant caste and its relevance to village power today. Answer in...", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Dominance built on numbers, land and office predicts everyday village authority better than ritual rank, and reserved Panchayat representation now contests that authority without displacing it.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication.

Qualification: State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

5. **Claim and named evidence:** Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Dominance built on numbers, land and office predicts everyday village authority better than ritual rank, and reserved Panchayat representation now contests that authority without displacing it.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For “Examine the concept of the dominant caste and its relevance to village power today. Answer in...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Assess the social consequences of agrarian change for rural stratification in India. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Agrarian change has restructured caste-class power more often than it has dissolved it, because productivity gains required capital, non-farm income created differentiation inside castes, and land and office remain unevenly distributed.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position.
- Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it.
- High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains.
- Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result.
- The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village.

Qualified conclusion: Agrarian change has restructured caste-class power more often than it has dissolved it, because productivity gains required capital, non-farm income created differentiation inside castes, and land and office remain unevenly distributed.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on “Assess the social consequences of agrarian change for rural stratification in India. Answer...”, all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Agrarian change has restructured caste-class power more often than it has dissolved it, because productivity gains required capital, non-farm income created differentiation inside castes, and land and office remain unevenly distributed.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Agrarian change has restructured caste-class power more often than it has dissolved it, because productivity gains required capital, non-farm income created differentiation inside castes, and land and office remain unevenly distributed.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess the social consequences of agrarian change for rural stratification in India. Answer...", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Critically examine whether formal representation in Panchayats has converted into substantive rural social power. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Reservation has created mandated voice and genuine agenda-setting in some villages while informal dominant-caste networks retain control through proxy office-holders in others, so representation is a necessary but insufficient condition.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control.
- Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy.
- M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis.
- Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it.
- Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them.

Qualified conclusion: Reservation has created mandated voice and genuine agenda-setting in some villages while informal dominant-caste networks retain control through proxy office-holders in others, so representation is a necessary but insufficient condition.

Demand decoding: The directive **critically examine** requires a direct position on "Critically examine whether formal representation in Panchayats has converted into substantive...", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Reservation has created mandated voice and genuine agenda-setting in some villages while informal dominant-caste networks retain control through proxy office-holders in others, so representation is a necessary but insufficient condition.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Reservation has created mandated voice and genuine agenda-setting in some villages while informal dominant-caste networks retain control through proxy office-holders in others, so representation is a necessary but insufficient condition.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise six to eight points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For “Critically examine whether formal representation in Panchayats has converted into substantive...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Evaluate the claim that rural India is connected to markets yet remains socially stratified. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Connection and stratification are compatible, because migration and markets change which resource carries power rather than abolishing the hierarchy, and national labour indicators cannot settle a village-level power question.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types.
- Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it.
- Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle.
- Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator.
- The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village.
- High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains.

Qualified conclusion: Connection and stratification are compatible, because migration and markets change which resource carries power rather than abolishing the hierarchy, and national labour indicators cannot settle a village-level

power question.

Demand decoding: The directive **evaluate** requires a direct position on “Evaluate the claim that rural India is connected to markets yet remains socially stratified....”, all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Connection and stratification are compatible, because migration and markets change which resource carries power rather than abolishing the hierarchy, and national labour indicators cannot settle a village-level power question.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Connection and stratification are compatible, because migration and markets change which resource carries power rather than abolishing the hierarchy, and national labour indicators cannot settle a village-level power question.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise six to eight points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for

causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

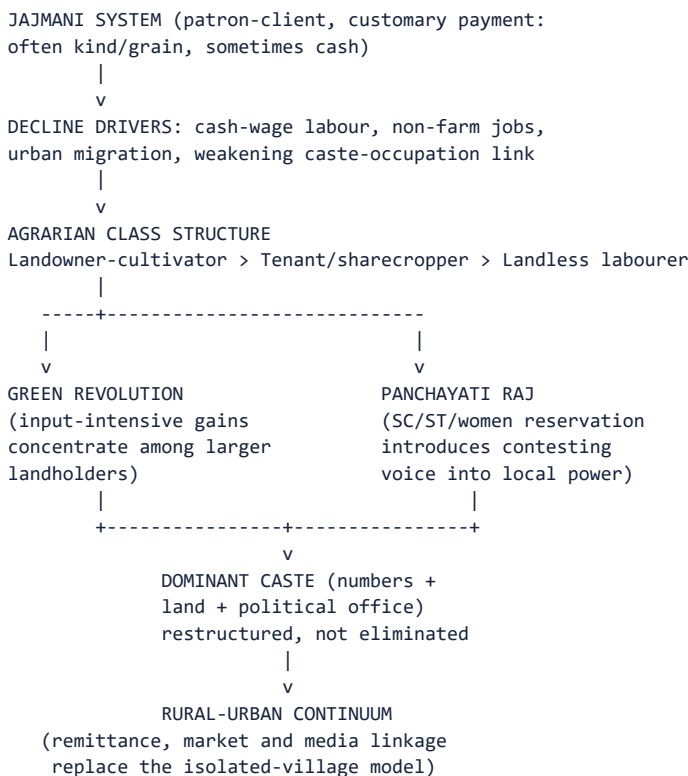
Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For “Evaluate the claim that rural India is connected to markets yet remains socially stratified....”, replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Subject: Indian Society | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS Paper:** GS-I. **Core area:** The jajmani-decline causal chain, dominant-caste power theory, Green Revolution class differentiation, and rural-urban continuum boundary cases. **Grounded in:** M.N. Srinivas's village sociology; MoSPI PLFS 2023-24 and PLFS Annual Report 2025; no direct 2024/2025 GS-I PYQ (flagged honestly as an older-pattern recurring theme). **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = inference/analysis | **CURRENT:** = current anchor. *Companion:* basic/05_Rural-Society-and-Agrarian-Change.md.

1. Architecture



Analytical claim: ANALYSIS: Agrarian change can restructure caste-linked village power rather than dissolve it. Green Revolution benefits were often unequal in irrigated, input-intensive settings, while Panchayati Raj reservation introduced institutional contestation; the balance between market, electoral and older personalised ties remains region- and village-specific.

2. Concepts and distinctions

Concept	Precise meaning
FACT: Jajmani system vs cash-wage labour market	Jajmani was a hereditary, personalised patron-client exchange whose customary payments often included kind/grain and could vary locally; a cash-wage labour market is more contractual and less tied to caste-occupation inheritance. Neither description should be universalised across all villages or periods.
FACT: Dominant caste vs landowning class	Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, landholding and political office; landowning class is a class-level (economic) category that can cut across multiple castes - a dominant caste is usually, but not necessarily, coextensive with the largest landowning class in a village.
ANALYSIS: Rural-urban continuum vs rural-urban dichotomy	The dichotomy model treats villages and towns as structurally opposed (traditional versus modern); the continuum model, now more widely accepted, treats them as points on a single spectrum linked by migration, remittance and communication, with no village fully insulated from urban influence.
ANALYSIS: Green Revolution's differentiation effect vs its aggregate output effect	Aggregate output rose sharply in Green Revolution regions, but access to irrigation, credit, seeds and markets was unequal. Larger holdings often benefited earlier, potentially sharpening differentiation; later diffusion and local tenancy/crop conditions make the outcome region-specific.
ANALYSIS: Formal representation vs substantive power	Panchayati Raj reservation guarantees formal seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women; substantive decision-making power in many Panchayats still runs through informal dominant-caste networks (the "proxy sarpanch" phenomenon), showing formal inclusion does not automatically produce substantive authority.

3. Detailed causal chain

Jajmani-decline chain

1. Cash-crop commercialisation and non-farm employment opportunities reduce a patron household's dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers.
2. Service-caste members migrate to towns for wage labour, breaking the hereditary occupation-caste link.
3. ANALYSIS: Jajmani-like relations can persist for particular ritual or personalised services, but their location and payment form cannot be assumed from remoteness alone.

Green Revolution differentiation chain

1. High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser require upfront capital investment.
2. ANALYSIS: Larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier, potentially capturing a disproportionate share of productivity gains.
3. Small and tenant cultivators could face higher risk and input costs, but outcomes varied with tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions.
4. ANALYSIS: This can reinforce dominant-caste economic advantage even as it does not by itself determine political dominance, which depends additionally on numbers and office-holding.

Panchayati Raj restructuring chain

1. Reservation mandates SC/ST/women representation in Panchayat seats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis.
2. ANALYSIS: In some villages this produces genuine new voice and agenda-setting power for previously excluded groups.

3. **ANALYSIS:** In others, informal dominant-caste networks continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy for a locally dominant family or caste, limiting the reform's substantive effect - a widely observed implementation gap.

4. Institutional and reform architecture

- **ANALYSIS: Panchayati Raj reservation (cross-linked, institutional design in Governance):**

the sociological point here is that formal representation and substantive power can diverge, requiring disaggregated, village-level assessment rather than aggregate reservation-compliance statistics alone.

- **ANALYSIS: Land reform and tenancy security (cross-linked to Economy):** ceiling laws and tenancy-reform legislation are designed to loosen caste-class overlap by redistributing land access; their macro-economic implementation record is Economy's territory.

- **ANALYSIS: Self-Help Group and cooperative institutions:** rural SHGs and cooperatives (cross-linked to Governance/04) offer an alternative, non-caste-linked economic organisation channel that can gradually dilute dominant-caste economic gatekeeping.

5. Indian applications and boundary cases

- **ANALYSIS: Boundary case 1 - jajmani persistence:** a remote village where a family still calls on a traditional priestly caste for ritual officiating, paid partly in kind, shows residual jajmani-like practice surviving alongside a largely monetised local economy.

- **ANALYSIS: Boundary case 2 - proxy sarpanch:** a Panchayat where a reserved-seat woman chairperson's decisions are effectively made by her locally dominant-caste husband illustrates the formal-representation-versus-substantive-power gap.

- **ANALYSIS: Boundary case 3 - successful reservation outcome:** a Panchayat where an SC-reserved chairperson independently drives water and sanitation infrastructure decisions shows reservation converting into genuine substantive power.

- **ANALYSIS: Boundary case 4 - full rural-urban continuum:** a village where most households have at least one urban-migrant remitting income, satellite television is common, and a paved road connects to a nearby town shows the continuum model applying in practice.

6. Limitations and trade-offs

- **ANALYSIS: Aggregate-output-versus-distribution trade-off:** Green Revolution-style productivity gains can raise average rural income while worsening relative inequality within villages - a distinction any answer on agrarian change should make explicit.

- **ANALYSIS: Reservation-compliance-versus-substantive-power gap:** measuring reform success by seat-reservation compliance alone can overstate actual empowerment if proxy control persists - a recurring "policy-announcement is not outcome" trap.

- **ANALYSIS: Continuum-versus-residual-isolation tension:** while the rural-urban continuum describes most of India, some remote and difficult-terrain villages remain comparatively isolated, so the continuum model should not be applied without qualification to every village.

7. Must-Know Facts for Advanced Prelims

- **FACT:** M.N. Srinivas's "dominant caste" concept and Rampura village fieldwork are the standard anchor for any village-power-structure question.

- **FACT:** Jajmani commonly involved customary grain/in-kind payment, but cash and mixed forms existed. Its defining contrast with a cash-wage labour market is the hereditary, personalised patron-client relation.

- **FACT:** Panchayati Raj reservation extends to Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women, including rotating reservation of chairperson positions.

- **CURRENT:** PLFS 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator; PLFS Annual Report 2025, released March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December period.

- ANALYSIS: The "proxy representative" phenomenon (formal reserved-seat holder, substantive decision-maker elsewhere) is a well-documented empirical pattern in Panchayati Raj studies.

8. Advanced Prelims traps

- WRONG: Dominant caste and landowning class are identical categories. -> Dominant caste is a caste-level concept (numbers + land + office); landowning class is an economic category that can cut across multiple castes.

- WRONG: Green Revolution produced the same distributional outcome in every village. -> Access to irrigation, credit, tenancy security, crop and market conditions shaped who gained; early advantages often favoured larger or better-connected cultivators.

- WRONG: Panchayati Raj reservation has fully dissolved dominant-caste local power. -> Formal representation and substantive power can diverge, as the proxy-representative pattern shows.

- WRONG: The rural-urban continuum applies uniformly and without exception to every Indian village. -> Some remote, difficult-terrain villages remain comparatively isolated; the continuum is a general, not universal, description.

9. CURRENT: Current-anchor note

- CURRENT: PLFS 2023-24 remains a dated rural-workforce comparator. The **PLFS Annual Report 2025**, released March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the earlier July-June cycle. Use the exact period and rural indicator; do not present a labour-force share as an undated structural constant.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- ANALYSIS: No direct 2024/2025 GS-I Mains PYQ targets rural society/agrarian change specifically; this is flagged honestly rather than a fabricated question being presented as verified. When a rural-society question does appear, the expected analytical route is: define jajmani and its decline, apply the dominant-caste concept to village power, use the Green Revolution differentiation chain to explain intra-village inequality, and close with the formal-representation-versus-substantive-power gap in Panchayati Raj.

11. Mains-ready framework

Central thesis: Agrarian change can restructure, rather than automatically dissolve, caste-linked rural power. Monetisation and migration alter many personalised service ties; land, local office and networks can retain influence, while reservations can create genuine or constrained voice. Explain these mechanisms with regional variation instead of treating one jajmani or Green Revolution trajectory as universal.

1. Define jajmani precisely and explain its decline mechanism.
2. Distinguish dominant caste from landowning class as separate but overlapping categories.
3. Trace the Green Revolution's differentiation (not just aggregate-output) effect.
4. Apply the formal-representation-versus-substantive-power gap to Panchayati Raj.
5. Give one jajmani-persistence and one proxy-representative boundary case.
6. Flag the continuum-versus-residual-isolation qualification.
7. Cross-link land reform and cooperative/SHG institutions without re-deriving their mechanics.
8. Conclude with a restructuring, not disappearance, framing of caste-linked rural power.

12. Probable questions

- ANALYSIS: **Prelims:** Which sociologist's village fieldwork produced the concept of "dominant caste"?

- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks):** Distinguish between dominant caste and landowning class in the context of Indian rural power structures.

- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks):** Examine how the Green Revolution affected class differentiation

within Indian villages.

- ANALYSIS: **Mains (10 marks):** Why does Panchayati Raj reservation not always translate into substantive decision-making power for reserved-seat holders?

13. Study links

- FACT: Foundation companion: basic/05_Rural-Society-and-Agrarian-Change.md.
- FACT: advanced/02_Caste-System-Structure-and-Contemporary-Dynamics.md - dominant caste as a general mobility concept.
- FACT: Economy/basic/23_Poverty-Inequality-Social-Sector-and-Inclusive-Growth.md - land reform and tenancy-law mechanics.
- FACT: Governance/advanced/04_NGOs-SHG-and-Civil-Society-Stakeholders.md - SHG/cooperative social-capital mechanism and Panchayati Raj institutional design.
- FACT: advanced/10_Urbanisation-Problems-and-Remedies.md - the urban side of the continuum.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

Rural Society and Agrarian Change: RAPID CONCEPT AND EVIDENCE MAP

1. **Jajmani system:** The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash.
2. **Hereditary personalised tie:** What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test.
3. **Jajmani decline mechanism:** Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on.
4. **Residual service ties:** Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival.
5. **Agrarian class structure:** Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position.
6. **Caste-class overlap in the village:** Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it.
7. **Dominant caste:** M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis.
8. **Rampura evidence:** Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract.
9. **Dominant caste is not the landowning class:** Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive.
10. **Green Revolution differentiation:** High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains.
11. **Region-specific outcome:** Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result.

12. **Panchayati Raj reservation:** Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control.
13. **Formal representation versus substantive power:** Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy.
14. **Rural-urban continuum:** The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types.
15. **Continuum in practice:** Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it.
16. **Scope discipline on land law:** Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them.
17. **Periodic Labour Force Survey boundary:** Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle.
18. **Employment data cannot prove village power:** Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator.
19. **Which resource now carries power:** The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village.
20. **Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status:** No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands.

Rural Society and Agrarian Change: CLOSE-OPTION AND CAUSAL TRAPS

- Do not define jajmani by the absence of cash payment.
- Do not claim that jajmani relations have disappeared everywhere.
- Do not assume jajmani survival from remoteness alone.
- Do not equate the dominant caste with the ritually highest caste.
- Do not equate the dominant caste with the landowning class.
- Do not claim that land reform ended caste-class overlap in Indian villages.
- Do not assert one universal Green Revolution distributional outcome.
- Do not treat reserved Panchayat seats as proof of substantive decision power.
- Do not describe villages as isolated, self-contained traditional units.
- Do not re-derive land-ceiling or tenancy law inside a Society answer.
- Do not use a labour-force indicator to prove jajmani decline or caste dominance.
- Do not compare survey rounds without stating the reference period.
- Do not romanticise a timeless village republic.
- Do not invent a rural statistic, landholding share or village case study.

Rural Society and Agrarian Change: ANSWER-WRITING SPINE

DEFINE THE SOCIAL UNIT -> STATE THE BOUNDARY RULE AND WHO IS INCLUDED
-> GROUP NAMED EVIDENCE BY MECHANISM OF REPRODUCTION OR CHANGE
-> TEST COUNTER-CASES, REGIONAL VARIATION AND CATEGORY LIMITS
-> SEPARATE CORRELATION FROM CAUSATION AND LAW FROM SOCIAL ACCEPTANCE
-> CLOSE WITH A GRADED, POLICY-AWARE VERDICT AND A DATA CAVEAT

Rural Society and Agrarian Change: CURRENT-LINK AND DATA BOUNDARY

No additional live official item was verified for this topic on 2026-09-02. Only the dated official anchors already carried by the repository owners are used, each with its issuing body and date. The package invents no caste, tribe, demographic or agrarian statistic, no legal or constitutional claim and no policy status.

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/12: Jajmani anatomy

JAJMAN -> patron household, usually landholding
KAMIN -> designated hereditary service group
SERVICE -> barbering, laundry, priestly, carpentry, smithing
PAYMENT -> customary, often grain or kind, sometimes cash
MUST REMEMBER: Rural society combines caste, class, land, labour, credit, kinship, panchayat, market and state relations; agrarian change follows tenure reform, Green Revolution, mechanisation, commercialisation, feminisation, migration, non-farm diversification and ecological stress.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/12: What actually defined jajmani

NOT -> the absence of cash in the transaction
YES -> hereditary allocation of the service role
YES -> personalised patron-client obligation
YES -> caste occupation embedded in the village economy

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/12: Decline mechanism

COMMERCIALISATION -> patrons buy services in a market
NON-FARM WORK -> service castes migrate to towns for wages
DECOUPLING -> hereditary occupation-caste link breaks
RESIDUAL -> ritual and personalised ties survive in places

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/12: Agrarian class ladder

LANDOWNING CULTIVATOR -> controls land and surplus
TENANT OR SHARECROPPER -> cultivates with insecure claim
LANDLESS LABOURER -> depends on wage work
OVERLAP -> class often but not always tracks caste rank

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/12: Dominant caste test

NUMBERS -> locally numerous population
LAND -> significant share of village land
OFFICE -> control of Panchayat and political networks
RESULT -> local power can sit below the ritual top

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/12: Two categories kept apart

DOMINANT CASTE -> caste-level, numbers plus land plus office
LANDOWNING CLASS -> economic category cutting across castes
USUAL CASE -> the two largely coincide in a village
ERROR PREVENTED -> treating them as the same unit

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/12: Green Revolution differentiation

INPUT PACKAGE -> high-yielding seed, irrigation, fertiliser
REQUIREMENT -> upfront capital, credit and market access
EFFECT -> earlier adopters capture a larger share of gains
LIMIT -> outcome varies by crop, tenancy and region

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/12: Panchayat power test

RESERVED SEAT -> Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women
QUESTION -> who sets the agenda in practice
PROXY RISK -> informal dominant-caste network controls decisions
EVIDENCE NEEDED -> village-level, not a national statistic

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/12: Continuum against dichotomy

DICHOTOMY -> village traditional, town modern, sealed apart
CONTINUUM -> one spectrum linked by flows
FLOWS -> migration, remittance, trade, media, road and market
CAUTION -> linkage does not abolish remoteness or land relations

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 10/12: Scope discipline

SOCIETY OWNS -> jajmani, dominance, stratification, continuum
ECONOMY OWNS -> land ceiling, tenancy law, poverty aggregates
GOVERNANCE OWNS -> Panchayati Raj institutional design
RULE -> cross-refer the borrowing and label it
CLOSE DISTINCTION: Rural is not agricultural, landowner is not cultivator, farmer is not only title-holder, productivity is not income, agricultural labour is not bonded labour, and Panchayati Raj representation is not the same as effective decision-making power.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/12: Measurement boundary

PLFS 2023-24 -> dated rural workforce comparator
PLFS ANNUAL REPORT 2025 -> released March 2026, latest round
PERIOD -> January to December, not the older July to June cycle
LIMIT -> cannot prove jajmani decline or caste dominance
EVIDENCE LIMIT: Contrast Punjab-Haryana, eastern India, dryland Deccan, plantation, tribal and peri-urban regions; use Agriculture Census, Situation Assessment and labour data with period/coverage labels, and treat technology-policy correlations as mechanisms requiring land, water, market and power analysis.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/12: Rural answer spine

OPEN -> name the changing power relation, not a village portrait
BODY -> jajmani change, class structure, dominance, Panchayat
FRAME -> which resource now carries power in this village
CLOSE -> continuum verdict with the data and scope caveats